

Standard Operating Procedure

Pre-Imaging Safety Screening and Radiation-Safety Device Stop-Work

«Hospital Name» — Supports AAC.9.g, AAC.9.h, AAC.9.i

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» screens every patient and attendant for radiation or MRI risk before imaging, and what staff must do — including stopping the examination — when a required safety screening or device check has not been completed.

2. Scope

Applies to every patient and attendant entering an area with radiation or MRI exposure, and to every radiation-safety and monitoring device in use.

3. Responsibility

Imaging Staff: completes and documents screening before every exposure.

Radiation Safety Officer (RSO): ensures periodic testing of safety devices and removes any failed device from use immediately.

4. Procedure

4.1 Pre-imaging screening

1. Screen every patient in the child-bearing age group for pregnancy before any radiation exposure, and document the result.
2. Screen every MRI patient — and every attendant entering the MRI room — for magnetic substances or implants.
3. Obtain and document consent for contrast, sedation, or interventional imaging procedures before proceeding.
4. As hospital safety practice, if pregnancy status is positive or uncertain for a radiation examination, do not proceed until the radiologist or imaging in-charge has reviewed the case.

4.2 Safety device use and testing

1. Use appropriate shielding — aprons and shields in adequate numbers — for staff, patients, and attendants during every radiation exposure.
2. Issue TLD badges to every staff member working with radiation sources, and confirm the badge is worn consistently.
3. Test every lead apron and shield periodically (X-ray, fluoroscopy, or CT scout view) for cracks or damage, and document the result.
4. Replace TLD badges per the frequency set out in the Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004 — see Section 7, Reference 1.

5. The moment a safety device fails its test, remove it from use immediately and open a CAPA record.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not proceed with radiation or MRI exposure when required safety/risk screening has not been completed and documented for the patient, or for any attendant entering the imaging area.

Do not proceed when a required radiation-safety or monitoring device has failed its periodic test (for example, a cracked lead apron), or when required TLD badges are unavailable for staff working with radiation sources.

Stop-work applies to the imaging exposure or MRI examination — it does not block emergency clinical stabilisation outside the imaging room.

The person who stops tells the Imaging In-Charge or the Radiation Safety Officer the same shift. Refusing to expose without screening, or with failed safety devices, is not a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Records 12–18 of the AAC.9 Required Records pack.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_AAC_9_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — AAC.9 policy
- SOP — Legal Compliance for Imaging Equipment and Stop-Work (AAC.8)

8. Review

Reviewed annually, or sooner after any near-miss involving screening or a failed safety device.

9. References

- Atomic Energy Regulatory Board, Government of India. (2004). Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004. <https://www.aerb.gov.in/images/PDF/RPR2004-with-corrigendum.pdf>